Introduction to the *Elements of Effective Practice for Mentoring*™, Fourth Edition

September 28, 2015

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Welcome!

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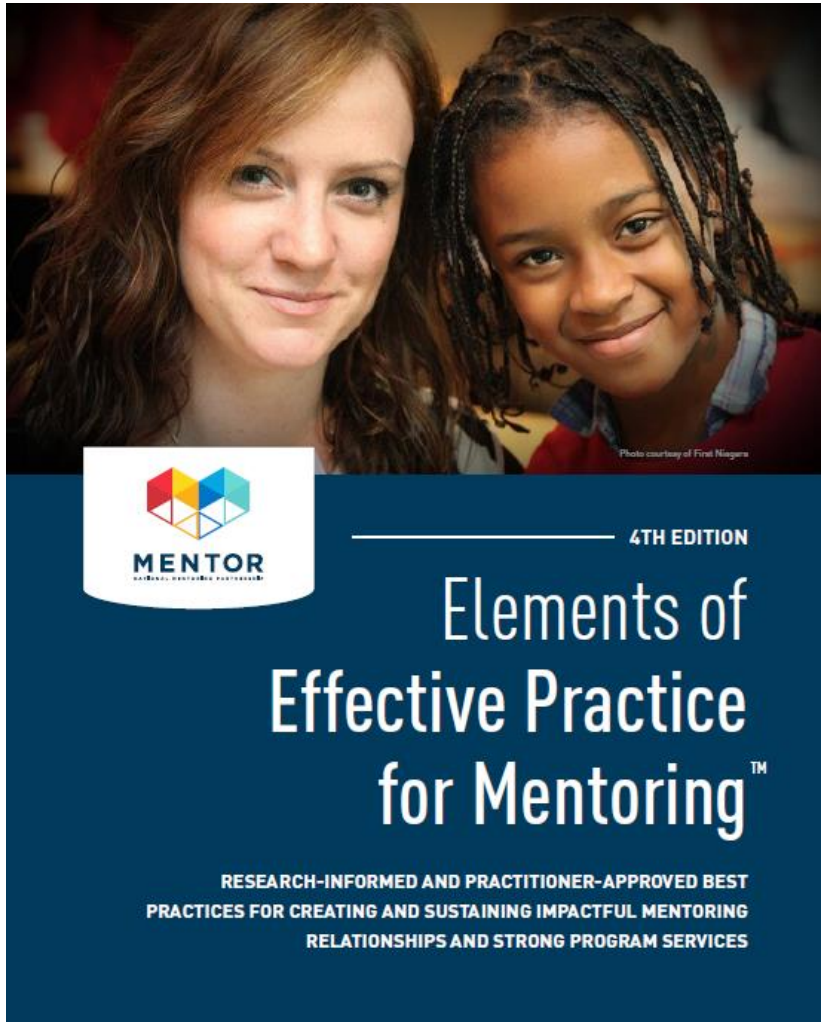
Fourth Edition Released!

- Available for download on the MENTOR website
- Print copies are available on order
- Special thanks to The MetLife Foundation and The Open Society Foundations for their generous support



Housekeeping

- Phones are muted
- Ask questions via the Q&A panel
- A recording of this event will be made available

A New Look for MENTOR!

MENTOR
THE NATIONAL MENTORING PARTNERSHIP

MENTOR
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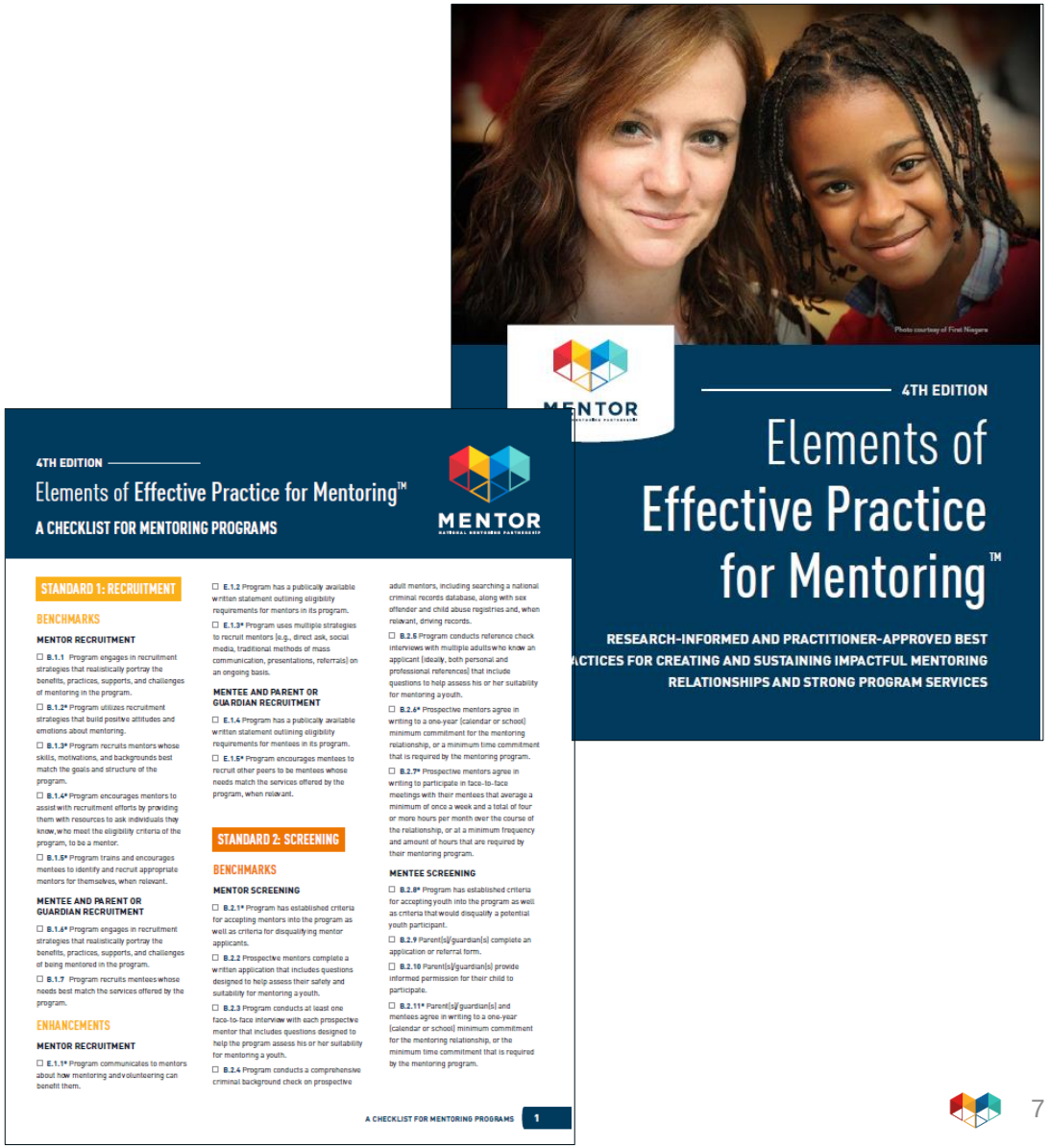
Webinar Goals

- Introduce you to the content of the fourth edition
- Review the methodology and development
- Provide context around history and value to the mentoring field
- Discuss overarching themes and new content
- Share information about support implementing effective practices

Getting a Copy

- Free PDF versions of the main *Elements* publication and companion “checklist” can be downloaded on the MENTOR website: www.mentoring.org
- Print copies of the *Elements* products can be ordered by calling MENTOR at 617-303-4600



Poll: How Familiar Are the *Elements*?

- Very familiar – *Apply them to our work at a meaningful level*
- Pretty familiar – *Read them and sometimes apply them*
- Not very familiar – *I have heard of them, but that's about it*
- No idea – *Is this about the Periodic Table?*

What are the *Elements of Effective Practice for Mentoring*™?

- A collection of research-informed practices for youth mentoring programs
- Evidence-based Standards with Benchmarks that programs can implement in delivering services
- Additional Enhancements that can promote relationship quality and strong outcomes
- Recommendations on program management, leadership, evaluation, and core principles youth mentoring organizations

Produced by MENTOR since 1990

In collaboration with:

- Researchers
- Practitioners
- National organizations
- *Mentoring Partnerships*
- Foundation partners

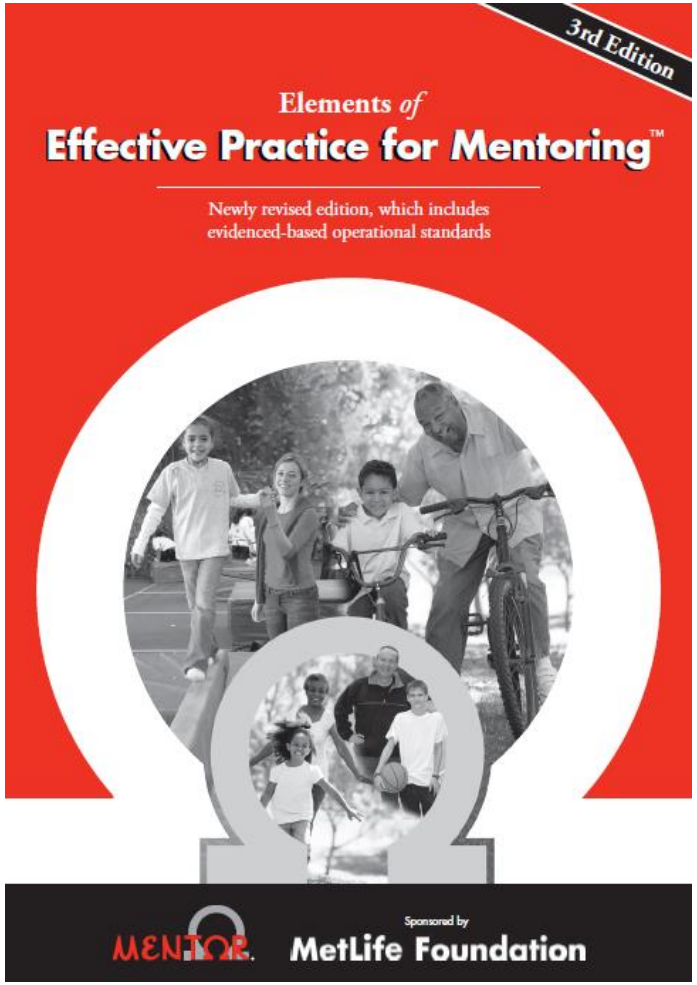
Use of the *Elements*

- Programs – *Implementation and continuous improvement*
- Policymakers and philanthropies – *Framework for investing in quality services*
- Training and technical assistance providers – *Foundation for professional development and quality assurance work*
- Researchers – *Starting point for understanding fidelity of implementation and indicators of effective practices*

The “Elements” of the *Elements*

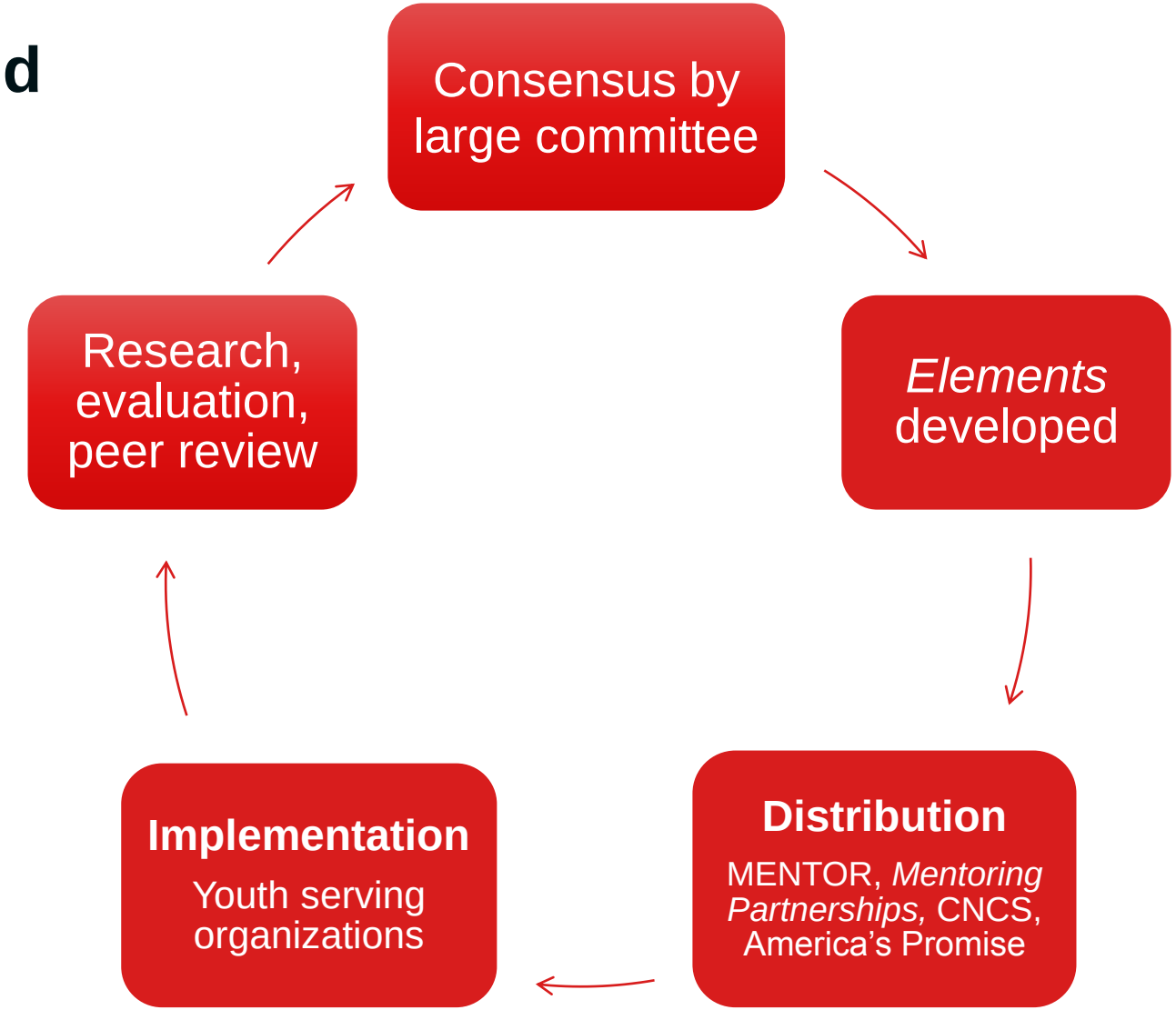
A Brief History of the EEPM

- First edition, 1990
- Second edition, 1999
- Third edition, 2009
- Fourth edition, 2015



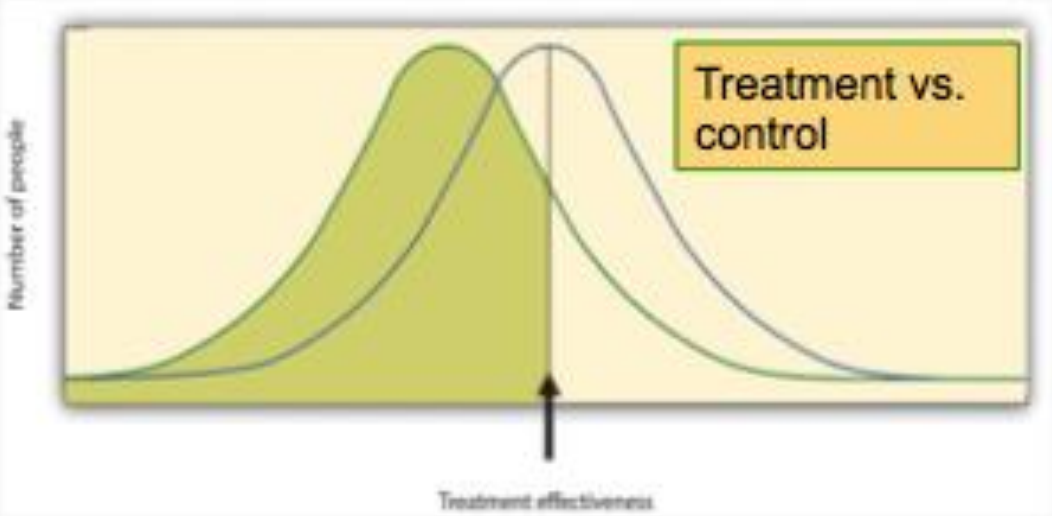
Third edition, 2009

1st and 2nd Editions



"My question is: Are we making an impact?"

How effective is youth mentoring?

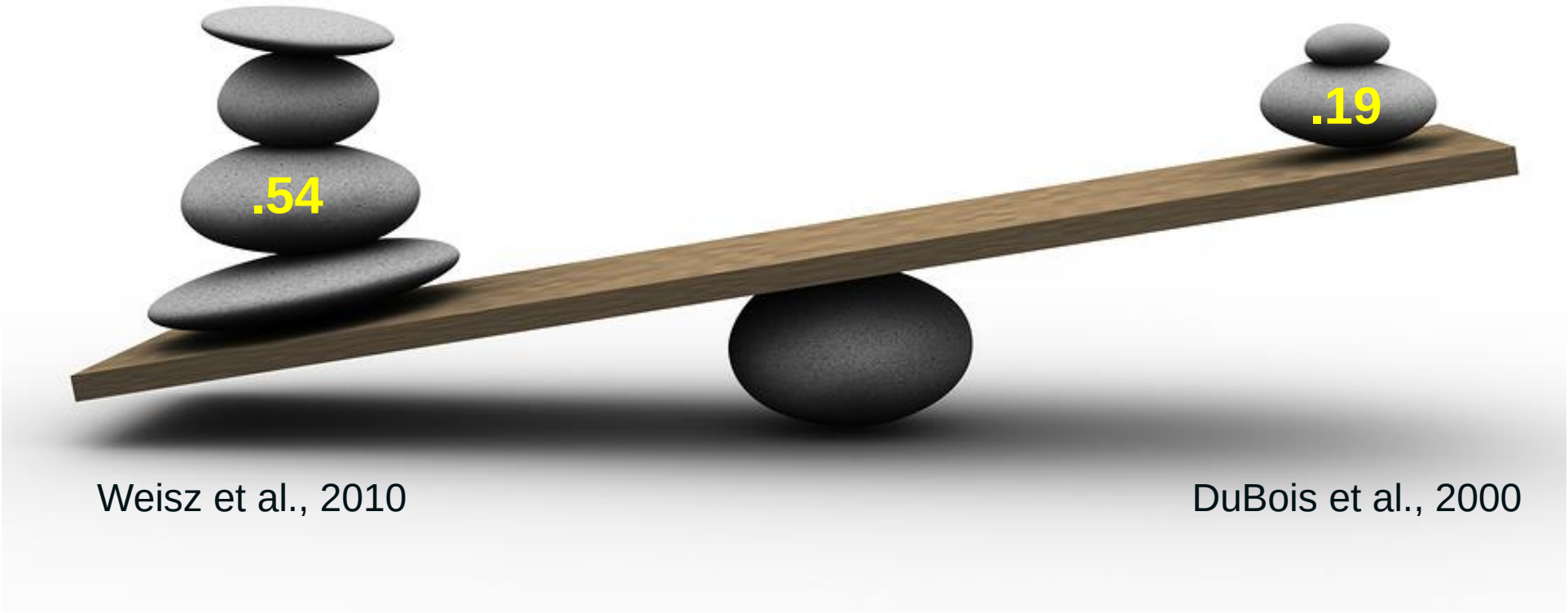


0.20 = "small" effect,
0.50 "= medium" effect,
0.80 = "large" effect.

For Comparison

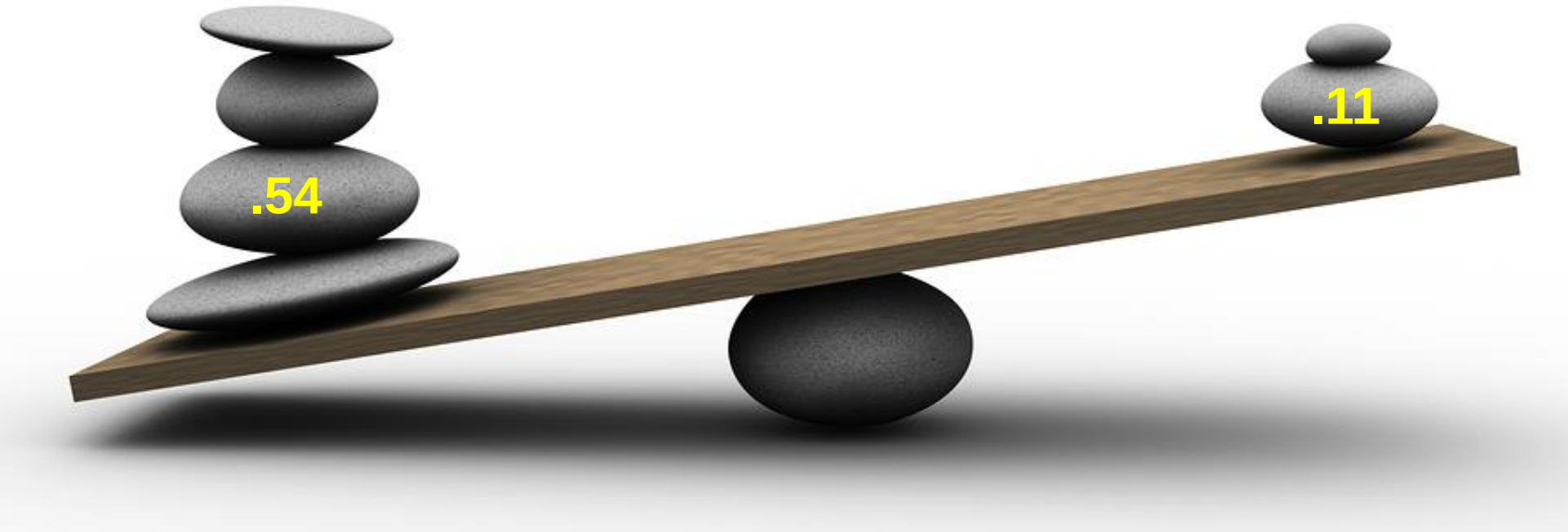
Evidence-Based Youth Psychotherapy

Youth Mentoring



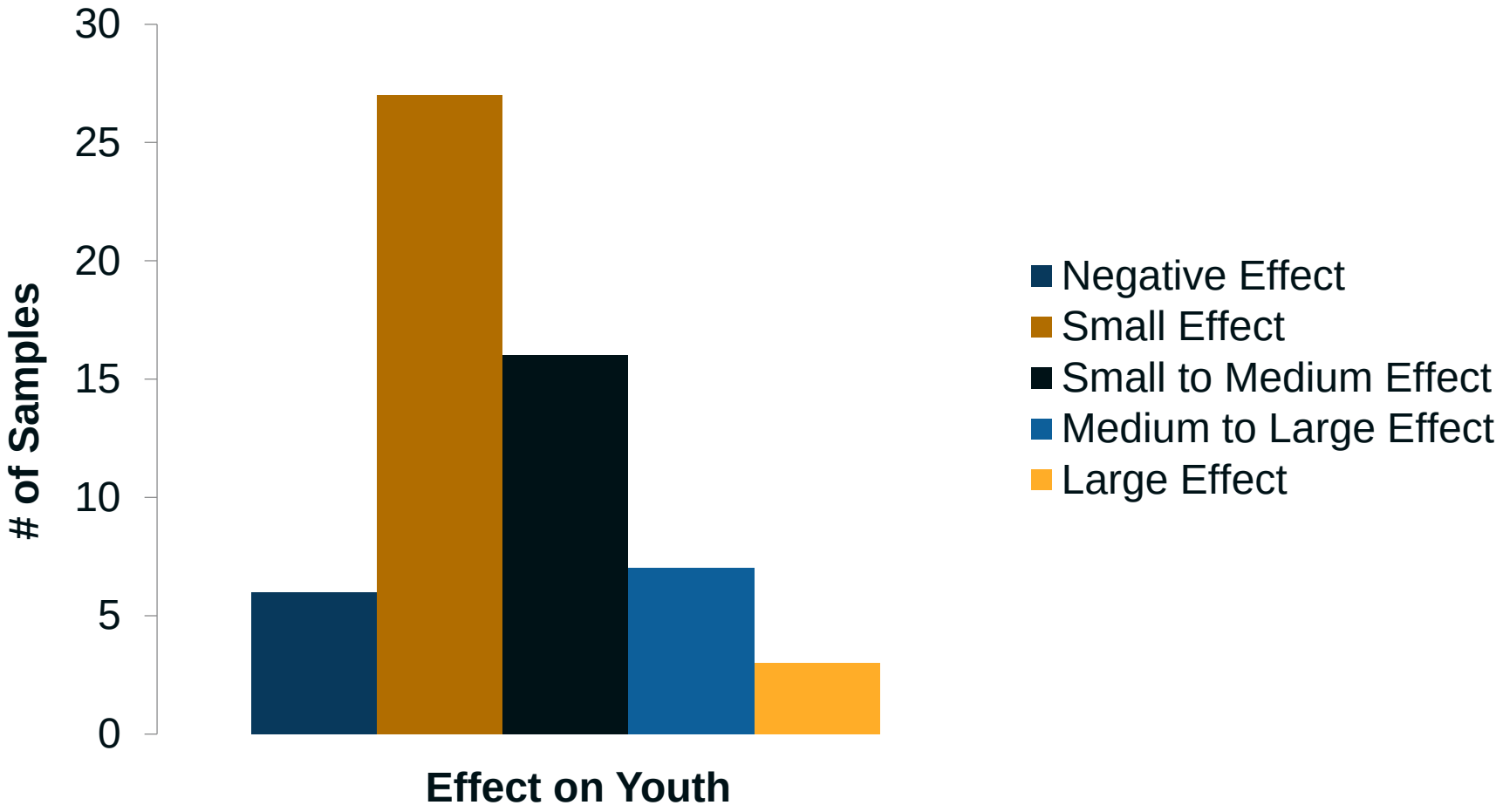
Evidence-Based Practice Comparison

Evidence-Based Youth Psychotherapy **“Usual Care” Youth Psychotherapy**

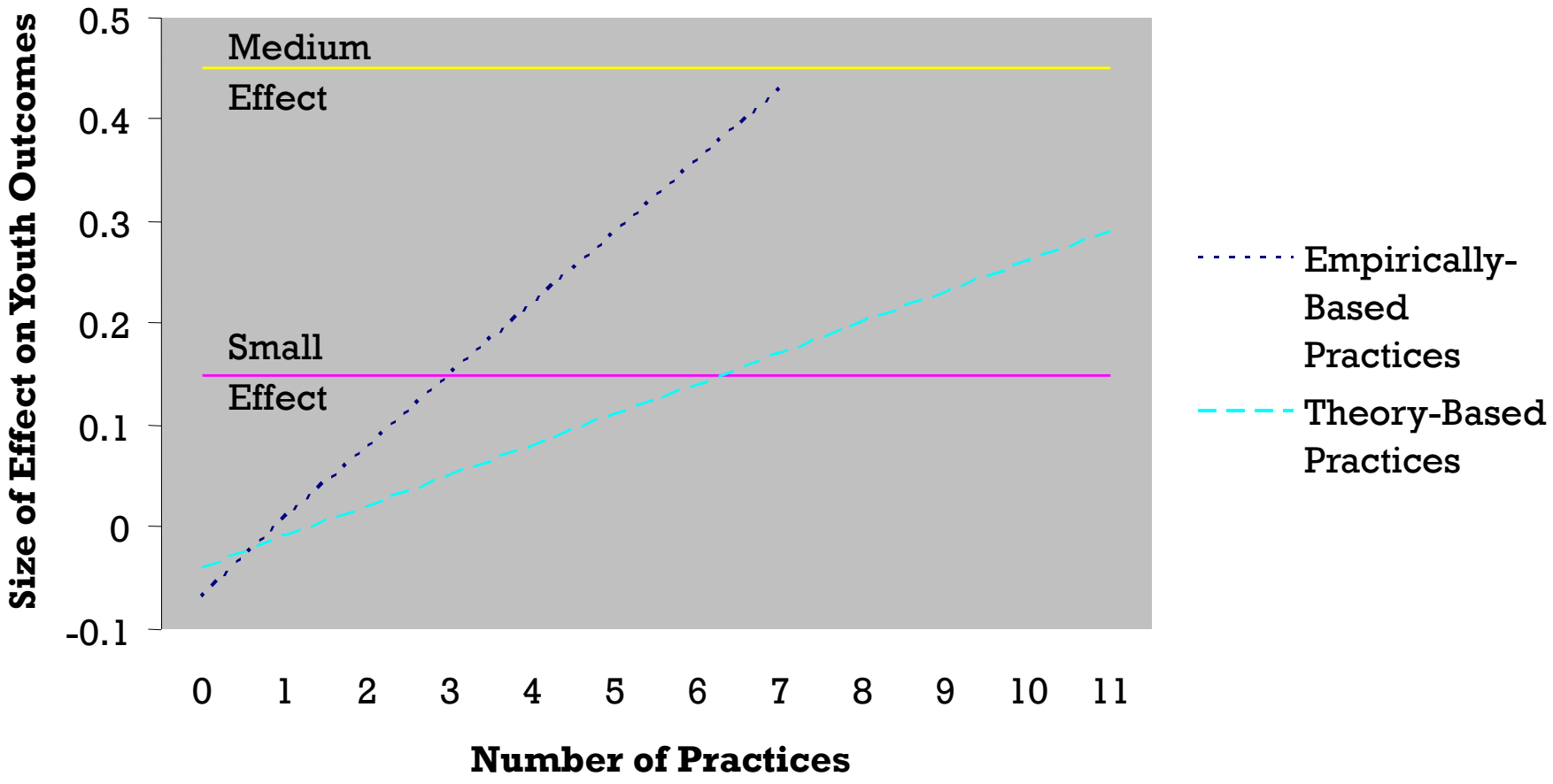


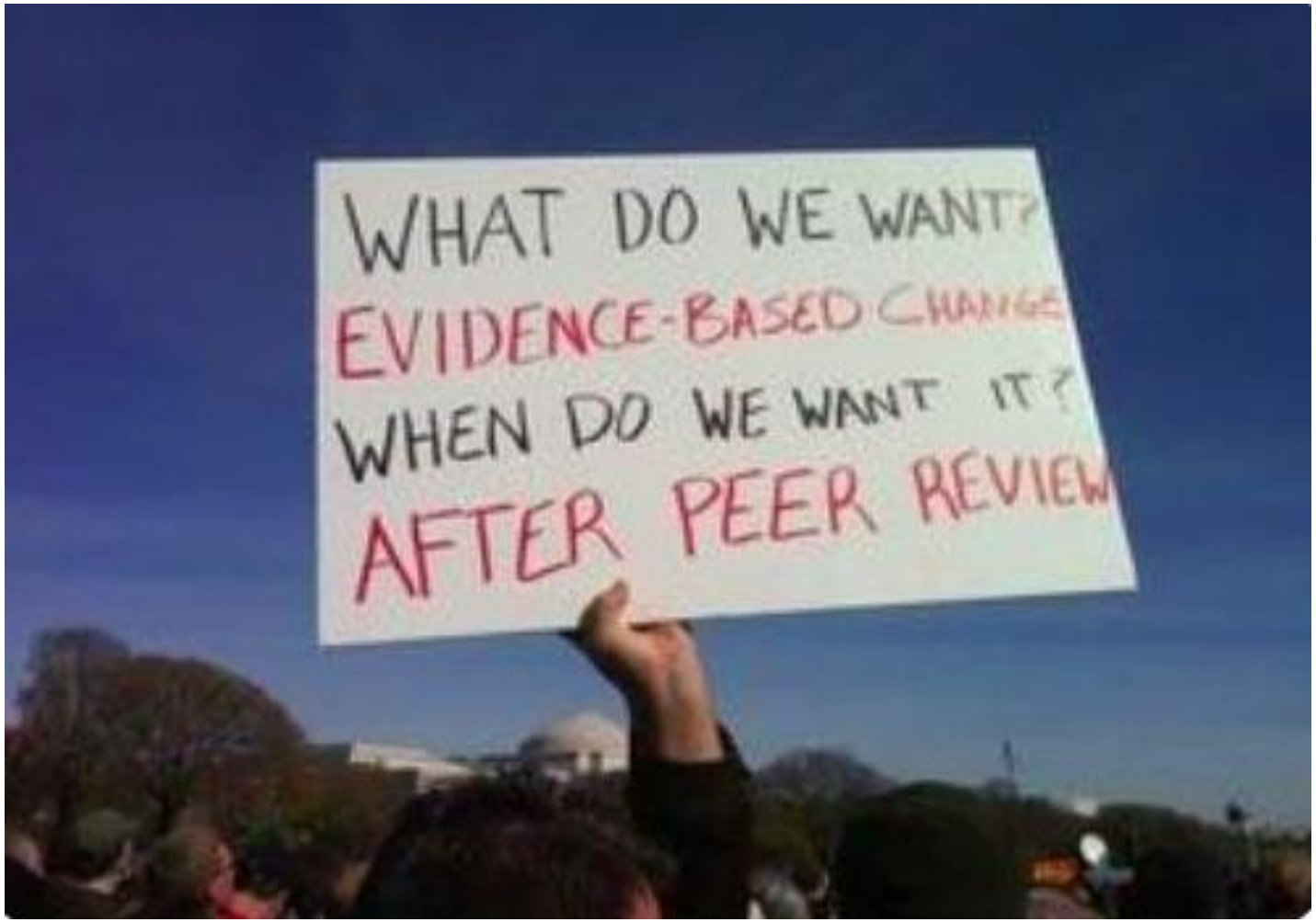
N = 32 studies, Avg. ES (EB vs. UC) = .30, Weisz et al., 2006, American Psychologist

Range of Impacts for Mentoring



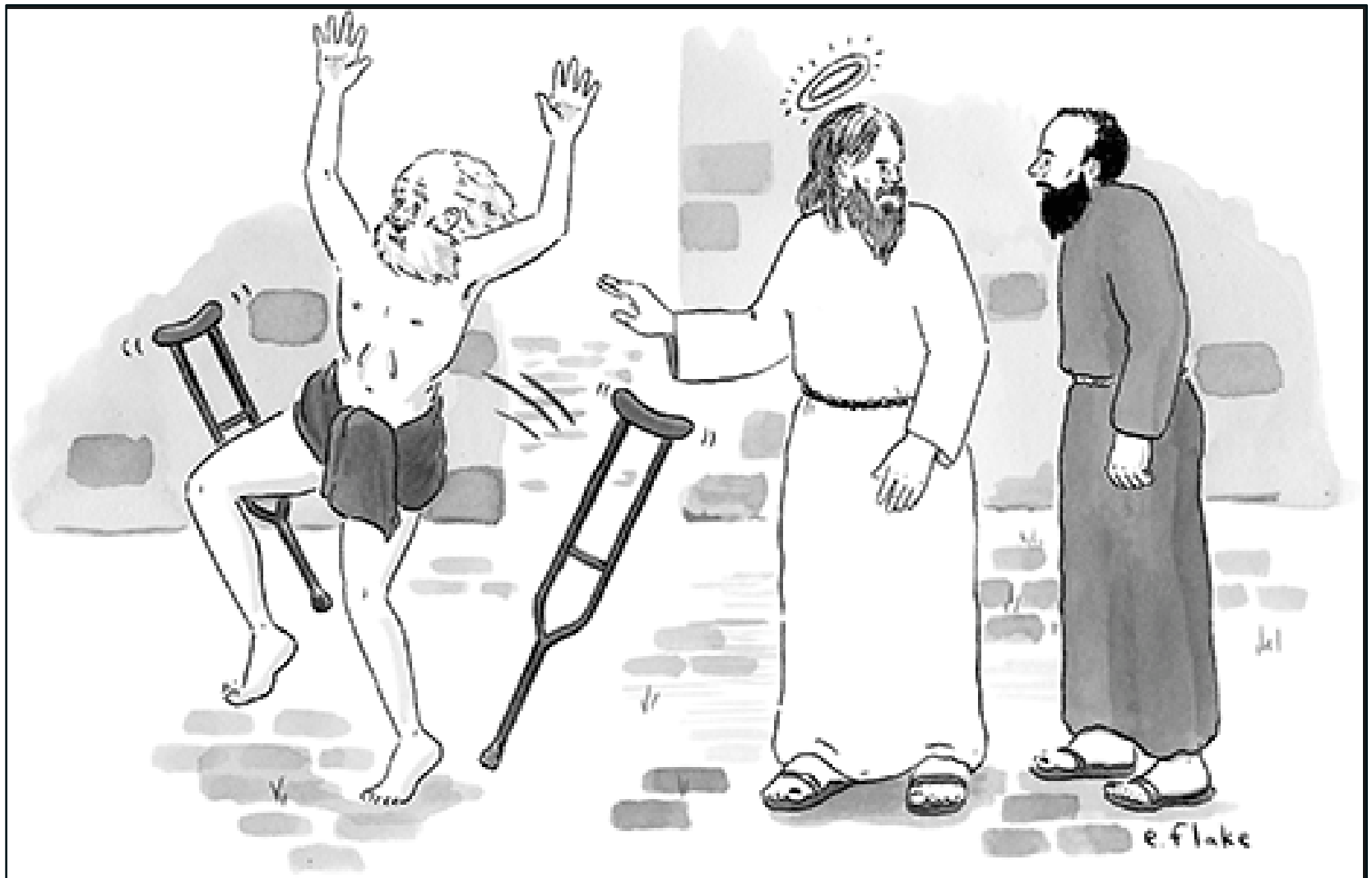
Effect Sizes




WHAT DO WE WANT?
EVIDENCE-BASED CHANGE
WHEN DO WE WANT IT?
AFTER PEER REVIEW

The Peer Review Process

- Researcher authors paper
- Editor makes initial acceptance
- Subject matter experts review quality of research and reasoning
- Returned to editor with recommendation
- Researcher revises based on feedback
- Editor does final review and publishes or rejects



"Yeah, but good luck getting it peer-reviewed."

3rd Edition

Review of peer-reviewed research

Engagement with practitioners

Elements developed

Distribution

MENTOR, *Mentoring Partnerships,* CNCS, America's Promise

Implementation

Youth serving organizations

Research, evaluation, peer review

2012 Meta-Analysis of Youth Mentoring

- Encompassed 73 independent evaluations (1999-2010)
- The overall effect size was .21, collapsing across studies and outcomes
- The average follow-up effect size across the studies was .17

DuBois, Portillo, Rhodes, Silverthorn, & Valentine(2012). *Psychological Science in the Public Interest*

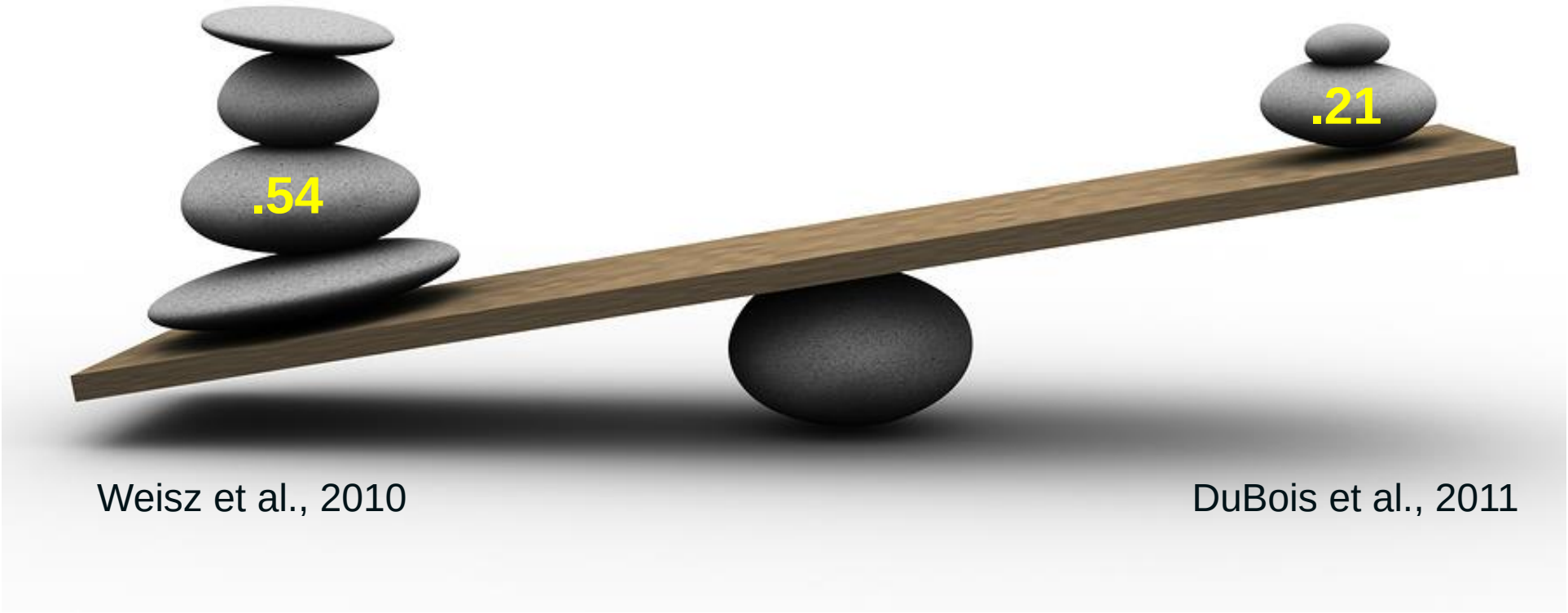
Comparison with Other Interventions

Moderator	Mentor Meta-analysis	Other Meta-analyses
Attitudinal/Motivational	0.19	0.23- 0.25
Social/Relational	0.17	0.15-0.26
Psychological/Emotional	0.15	0.10-.0.24
Conduct Problem	0.21	.02-0.41
Academic/School Attitudes Grades Achievement tests	0.21 0.19 0.24 0.18	0.11-0.27 0.14 0.22 0.11-0.24
Physical Health	0.06	0.08-0.41

A New Comparison

Evidence-Based Youth Psychotherapy

Youth Mentoring



CENTER for
EVIDENCE-BASED
MENTORING
PUTTING RESEARCH into ACTION

Development of the Fourth Edition

Dr. Janis Kupersmidt
President and Senior Research Scientist
innovation Research & Training

Literature Review Methodology

- 400+ peer-reviewed journal articles describing the findings of empirical studies; book chapters and reports too
- 80+ peer-reviewed journal articles of empirical studies were emphasized
- Literatures examined: mentoring; clinical child psychology; child/developmental psychology; social work; volunteerism; positive youth development
- Data bases used: PubMed, PsychInfo, GoogleScholar
- Many search terms: mentor* and positive youth development as well as screen*, recruit*, train*, match*, monitor*, support*, close, closure, termination

Development of the Benchmarks and Enhancements

- First draft by Drs. Rhodes, Kupersmidt, & Stelter
- Draft reviewed and revised in 2-day retreat with Steering Committee
- Subsequent drafts reviewed by Advisory Committee
- Draft reviewed by Short Course on the *Elements* conducted prior to the 2015 National Mentoring Summit
- Draft reviewed by State Mentoring Partnerships

Development of Justifications and Final Product

- Individual chapters drafted by Kupersmidt, Stelter, Garringer, and Malley
- Each chapter reviewed by entire Steering Committee
- Entire document reviewed by State Mentoring Partnerships
- Final edits, design, and print production

Structure of the Standards

- Standards
  - 6 core standards that follow the life cycle of a mentoring relationship
  - focus on program practices that support the development and maintenance of effective mentoring relationships

- Benchmarks
  - mentoring program practices required to meet the standard
  - based upon safety concerns or evidence-informed

Structure of the Standards (cont.)

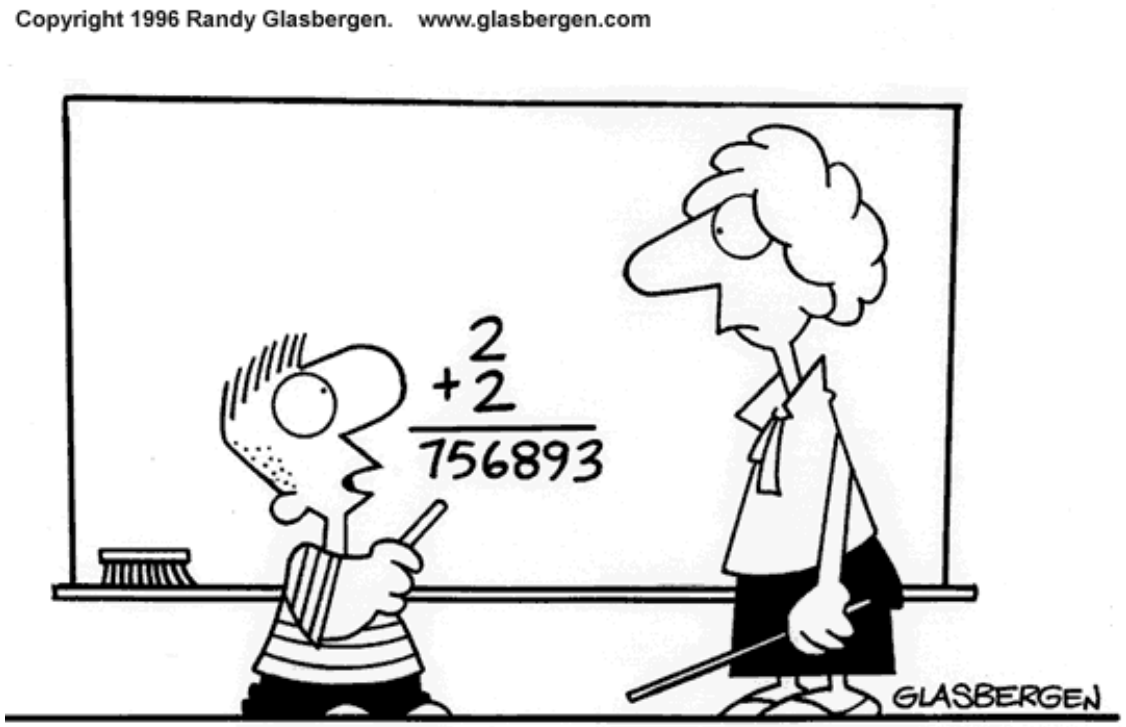
- Enhancements
  - recommended mentoring program practices suggested and informed primarily by well-functioning mentoring programs (“best practices”)
- Justifications
  - rationale or research designed to support the Benchmark requirements or recommended Enhancements
- Exceptions and Special Considerations
  - guidance on when some recommendations may not be applicable to some programs

Program Planning and Management

Practitioner- and TA provider-sourced recommendations

- Planning and Design
- Leadership and Oversight
- Program Evaluation
- Core Principles of Mentoring Relationships and Programs

Questions?



"In an increasingly complex world, sometimes old questions require new answers."

What’s Different in the Fourth Edition?

Dr. Rebecca Stelter
Research Scientist
innovation Research & Training

One Difference in Standards

5 of the 6 Standards remain the same: Recruitment, Screening, Training, Monitoring and Support, Closure

However…

- The Matching Standard was expanded to include “Initiation”
- It was determined that it is important to include specific mentoring practices related to Initiation to support developing effective matches
- Initiation is fully integrated into the Matching process

Theme: Review of Literature Outside the Mentoring Field

- e.g. Recruitment Standard examined literature on volunteerism for recommendations regarding recruitment of mentors

Theme: Empowerment and Engagement of Mentees and Families

- Providing additional information and training to set realistic expectations about mentoring relationships
- Integrated involvement in recruitment, matching and initiation, monitoring and support, and closure

Theme: Emphasis on Policies and Documentation of Procedures

- Encouraging written plans for achieving Benchmarks and Enhancement
- Prioritizing safety
- More information sharing during training

Theme: Recognition of Innovations in the Mentoring Field

- Youth-initiated mentoring
- Program models besides one-to-one, community-based
  - Special consideration of school-based
- More consideration of closure practices
- Emphasis on evaluation

Getting Help Implementing Better Practices

- *Mentoring Partnerships – Network of 26 organizations across the country*
- National Mentoring Resource Center – *A project of OJJDP and MENTOR providing free technical assistance to any program*
- Collaborative Mentoring Webinar Series – *Monthly online learning opportunities*
- 2016 National Mentoring Summit – *70+ workshops for practitioners*
- iRT and the Center for Evidence-Based Mentoring – *Great sources of online training and research-to-practice knowledge*

Questions?

"Ms. Jones, there are a number of big questions here to see you. They say they won't leave until they have some answers."

www.NonprofitStrategyRevolution.org

Next Steps

- Order print copies by calling MENTOR at 617-303-4600
- Next MENTOR webinar is October 15th - School-Based Mentoring: Strategic Interventions to Maximize Positive Youth Outcomes
- Short Course (January 27th) and workshops at the 2016 National Mentoring Summit (January 28th and 29th)
- Visit the National Mentoring Resource Center to request technical assistance: www.nationalmentoringresourcecenter.org

Thank you for joining us today!

Mike Garringer
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